Study privacy notice

I have read the privacy policy below and consent to taking part in this study. By consenting, I agree to the processing of my data for this research project.

I agree to upload a selfie as part of this survey. I understand that a blurred, thumbnail-sized version of this selfie will be temporarily stored by the researchers conducting this survey. With my explicit agreement (requested separately later in the survey), other Prolific users may also see my blurred selfie.

Who is responsible for the study?

Responsible for the execution of the study and therefore for the processing of your data:

Daniel Evans
University of Bonn
Niebuhrstrasse 5
53113 Bonn
Germany
Email: daniel.evans@uni-bonn.de

What are the purposes of the study?

In this project, we are interested in people's personalities, behavior, and task performance.

What happens to my data?

All participating employees and scientists work in accordance with the provisions of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), the Federal Data Protection Act and the relevant State Data Protection Acts.

We collect:

- Your Prolific ID;
- Your blurred selfie;
- Your survey responses;
- Messages you write;
- Records of when and how often you switch to other tabs or windows, but not where you switch to.

Prolific IDs, the links between these IDs and research records, and blurred selfies will be deleted after a six-month retention period ending 11 May 2027. Access to these sensitive data will be restricted to authorized members of the research team, subject to the storage arrangements and sharing with other study participants described in this notice.

Your Prolific ID will be used to link your participation to your study records and process your bonus payments.

You will be asked to take a selfie using your camera. Your selfie will be blurred locally in your browser, and you will be asked to confirm the blurred selfie before it is transmitted to us. The original, unblurred selfie will not be transmitted to or stored by the research team.

Your survey responses will be stored and statistically analysed. They will be retained indefinitely in anonymized form and may be shared in research replication packages. Results will be reported in a form that does not identify individual participants.

During the study, you will decide whether to send messages to other participants. If you choose to send a message, your accompanying selfie may also be shown to them. We may also collect other participants' impressions of your blurred selfie, such as perceived attractiveness. These messages will be sent during the second phase of our study, which begins after your data is collected and ends

on 11 May 2027. We will remove identifying details from messages and other free-text responses before retaining them for analysis. These messages will be retained indefinitely in anonymized form and may be shared in research replication packages, excluding selfies and any other potentially identifying details.

We record how often you switch away from a given page of the study to an alternative tab or window. We do not record where you switch to. This data will be retained indefinitely in anonymized form and may be shared in research replication packages.

Immediately after collection, all of the above data will be stored and statistically analysed. All results will be reported in a form that does not identify individual participants. No identifiable data will be shared with research partners or in replication packages.

The legal basis for processing all personal data collected in this study is your consent under Article 6(1)(a) of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR). You may withdraw consent and request deletion by contacting the research team through Prolific or at daniel.evans@uni-bonn.de. Following withdrawal, we will stop displaying your selfie and delete your stored data if it can still be linked to you. Withdrawal does not affect the lawfulness of processing carried out before withdrawal.

This data will be stored in a Heroku Postgres database. The survey application is hosted on Heroku, a Salesforce service, in its US region. Data are transmitted using HTTPS. Researcher access is password-protected and restricted to authorized members of the research team. Copies of the data will also be stored locally on password-protected computers used by authorized members of the research team.

Salesforce publishes a Data Processing Addendum describing its confidentiality and security obligations and safeguards for international transfers, including EU standard contractual clauses. Further information is available in the Salesforce Data Processing Addendum.

Which rights do I have?

You have the right to obtain information about the personal data stored about you (Art. 15 GDPR). Should incorrect data be processed, you have the right to rectification (Art. 16 GDPR). When the legal requirements are met, you have the right to request the deletion or restriction of the processing and submit an objection against the processing of your data (Art. 17, 18 and 21 GDPR).

Where the legal requirements are met, you also have the right to receive the personal data you provided in a structured, commonly used, machine-readable format and to transmit those data to another controller (Article 20 GDPR).

To exercise your rights or withdraw consent, contact Daniel Evans at daniel.evans@uni-bonn.de or through Prolific. You may also contact the University of Bonn's Data Protection Officer at datenschutz@uni-bonn.de.

You have the right to complain to the competent data protection authorities.

The consent given here can be withdrawn at any time with effect for the future. However, if your survey data has already been anonymized, it can no longer be associated with you. Therefore we are unable to "remove" your data from the result.

Further information

This notice describes the arrangements specific to this study. The University of Bonn's data protection policy concerns its website; its research-data policy describes the framework for managing and retaining research data.

University of Bonn data protection policy:
https://www.uni-bonn.de/en/data-protection-policy

University of Bonn research-data policy:
https://www.forschungsdaten.uni-bonn.de/en/rdm-uni-bonn/research-data-policy-at-the-university-of-bonn

Declaration of Consent

I was sufficiently informed in writing about the scientific study. I have read and understood the information regarding my participation. All questions in this context were satisfactorily discussed and answered. I also had sufficient time to decide whether or not to participate in this study.

I have been informed that my participation is entirely voluntary.

I know that I can withdraw my consent to participate in this study at any time without providing any reason and without having personal disadvantages. If I withdraw my consent to participate in this study, I have the right to request the deletion of my personal data stored within the scope of this study, subject to applicable legal requirements. Data that have already been anonymized can no longer be associated with me.

In case of any publishing by a scientific journal, the data will not indicate who has participated in this study. The applicable data protection laws protect my personal data.